Chapter 10: Architecture Roles, Skills, and Competencies

Study Guide – based on Mastering the TOGAF® Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 10 (pp. 247-278)

Overview

Chapter 10 (pp. 247-278) of *Mastering the TOGAF® Standard* by Eric Jager covers the **people side of the Architecture Capability**: which architecture roles exist, what separates a job from a role and an assignment, and which skills and competencies each role needs. It continues directly from Chapter 9. Establishing the Architecture Capability and forming an architecture team are among the first activities of the Preliminary Phase, and both depend on defining the right roles, skills, and competencies. The chapter draws mainly on the TOGAF Series Guide *Architecture Roles and Skills* (G249, released September 2024), which replaced the older *Architecture Skills Framework* (G198). It is part of the GREEN and GOLD reading tours.

The chapter has four main ideas:

- Three core roles plus the Chief Architect specialization.
- Two ways of looking at the Segment Architect role: horizontal and vertical.
- TOGAF's eight skill categories and four proficiency levels.
- Jager's own list of ten competencies, which he adds because TOGAF does not define competencies.

Detailed Section Breakdown

Introduction (pp. 247-248)

A skills framework can be used to identify the roles and skills needed for the capability. Despite the Series Guide, ambiguity about job descriptions, roles, and assignments persists in practice and leads to misunderstandings about what architects are responsible for.

10.1 Difference Between Jobs, Roles, and Assignments (pp. 248-249)

Term	Definition (Architecture Roles and Skills Series Guide)
Job	The formal position someone holds, usually defined by an employment contract and usually tied to hierarchical position in the organization.
Role	The expected set of activities, typically tied to a specific skill set.
Assignment	A specific task or project a person is responsible for, often within the scope of their job and role, though not exclusively.

- There is still little consensus in practice. Many organizations do not know whether “Enterprise Architect” is a job or a role. Because of this, architecture is still often placed in the IT department, which requires different skills from a strategic team that turns strategy into execution (pp. 248-249).
- Most ambiguity arises when roles are tied to domains, for example “Technical Architect” or “Application Architect.” To remove this ambiguity, TOGAF created the **Segment Architect** profile. It describes a **job** (not a role or an assignment) and comes as a complete package with a role description and responsibilities (p. 249).

10.2 Core Architecture Roles (pp. 249-255)

The Series Guide recognizes that one person may hold several roles and one role may be shared by several people. It offers a starting point to be tailored. It defines **three primary viewpoints: enterprise, segment, and solution**, which correspond to the **three core architecture roles** (Figure 10-1, p. 250). Specialist, user, and stakeholder roles are not detailed by TOGAF. Professional frameworks and associations cover those.

Moving from the Chief Architect down through the Enterprise Architect to the Segment Architect, each role brings a different depth of expertise, leadership, and governance. Most organizations have three to seven levels of management, but TOGAF starts with a minimal **three-tier** model that can be extended (pp. 250-251). In Figure 10-2 (p. 251), a dashed line around the Chief and Enterprise Architect shows that the **Chief Architect is a specialization of the Enterprise Architect**, not a separate role.

Role	Focus and responsibilities	Leads / works with
Chief Architect (special case of Enterprise Architect) (pp. 251-252)	Integrates the EA view into the wider strategic and operational context. A seasoned, influential leader, internal or an external advisor, who unifies executives and board members around the vision for the Architecture Landscape. Establishes roadmaps across business and technology domains and is accountable for the landscape's governance and alignment.	Leads Enterprise, Segment, and Solution Architects plus specialists.
Enterprise Architect (pp. 252-253)	Steers transformative change across the whole organization. Leads major initiatives with a seat at the table with senior decision-makers. Builds roadmaps that span entire business segments and defines the guiding principles and policies. Its mission is the framework for integration, interoperability, and governance.	Leads Segment Architects, Solution Architects, and specialists. Coaches and mentors.
Segment Architect (formerly Domain Architect) (pp. 253-254)	Manages specific business or technical capabilities within a segment. Defines, shapes, and governs systems, subsystems, and components. Creates blueprints for the segment and ensures policies and standards are met.	Collaborates with other architects. Organizes technical specialists and Solution Architects.
Solution Architect (pp. 254-255)	Drives delivery of new or evolved capabilities. Breaks solutions into systems, subsystems, and components and integrates them into a roadmap through targeted **Transition Architectures**. Ensures each solution follows principles, policies, and standards from specification to implementation.	Works closely with technical and business teams to meet end-to-end service levels.

Jager's observation (author's view): in Europe, few organizations recognize the Chief Architect role, so its duties usually fall to the Enterprise Architect. The two roles are typically combined (p. 252).

10.3 The Role of the Segment Architect (pp. 255-263)

The same Segment Architect **job** can carry different **roles**. Whether the job assignment is technical-infrastructure work or business work determines the role description, the required skills, and even where in the organization the person sits (for example, inside IT) (p. 255). Segments can be viewed in two ways:

Perspective	Basis	What a segment is	Source in TOGAF
Horizontal (profession view) (pp. 256, 258-260)	The four architecture domains	A domain: Business, Data, Application, or Technology. The Segment Architect specializes as Business, Data, Application, or Technology Architect.	Fundamental Content

Perspective	Basis	What a segment is	Source in TOGAF
Vertical (organizational view) (pp. 256-263)	Business domains or pillars by core activity or service (e.g., Research, Consultation, Treatment in healthcare)	A pillar that contains (parts of) all four architecture domains, forming a Segment Architecture.	Not in the Fundamental Content; somewhat hidden in the Series Guide

TOGAF definitions quoted (p. 256): *a segment groups capabilities in a structured way, often as part of a larger portfolio or specific change program*, and a **domain** reflects any useful grouping of capabilities to be managed, with four particular segment-based viewpoints: business, application, data, and technology.

Jager's critique of the vertical view (author's view, pp. 257-258): each pillar contains several domains. Business, Data, and Application often sit together, while Technology is separated because in nine out of ten cases it belongs to IT. Few architects can cover all of these domains, so organizations invent new roles. His example is a "**Tribe Architect**" in an agile organization, which he calls part of an "uncontrollable proliferation" of often nonsensical roles.

10.3.1 The horizontal perspective (pp. 258-260)

The core roles map neatly onto the **four Architecture Capabilities from Chapter 9** (Figure 10-4, p. 259; Figure 10-5, p. 260):

Architecture Capability (Ch. 9)	Core role	Example specializations
Support Strategy	Chief Architect / Enterprise Architect. The Chief Architect takes the strategic side if both exist. In smaller organizations the Enterprise Architect does both.	—
Support Portfolio and Support Projects	Segment Architect	Business, Data, Application, and Technology Architect
Support Solution Delivery	Solution Architect	Cloud, Network, and Software Architect

Each capability needs its own role. Combining roles into one creates ambiguity about who deploys and executes each capability (p. 260).

10.3.2 The vertical perspective (pp. 260-263)

- In the vertical view, a Segment Architect owns the architecture of one organizational pillar, which spans all domains (Figure 10-6, p. 261).
- Because this includes Application and Technology responsibility, the work becomes more substantive and operational, closer to Solution Architecture (p. 261).
- **Segment vs. Solution Architecture** (Figure 10-7, p. 262): a Solution Architecture describes a discrete, focused business operation and how IT supports it, and typically applies to a **single project or release**. A Segment Architecture covers a whole pillar, whose services may also be used by other departments.
- **Inconsistency flagged by Jager:** the Chapter 8 Governance Framework lists Chief, Enterprise, and **Domain** Architect, but not Segment or Solution Architect. The Series Guide uses "Segment Architect" instead of "Domain Architect" and places the Solution Architect under the Architecture Capability. The Open Group has said it is gradually fixing such inconsistencies (pp. 262-263).

Further reading: *Architecture Skills Framework* (G198) and *Architecture Roles and Skills* (G249).

10.4 Skills and Competencies (pp. 263-277)

The three core roles split the work as follows. The **Enterprise Architect** handles the strategic aspect. The **Segment Architect** details and refines specific architecture or business domains. The **Solution Architect** develops the details of proposed solutions and is a specialist in a subset (p. 264). Skills frameworks define the roles in a work area, the skills each role needs, and the depth of knowledge required. They are also used for consultancy, project staffing, and recruitment.

Skill categories (Table 10-1, p. 265)

Skill category	Examples
Application	Application management, API patterns, software design principles
Architecture	Modeling, building block design, high-level design, role definition, Architecture Principle design, high-level migration planning, systems development and integration methods, Security Architecture, patterns, requirements management, governance
Business	Enterprise organization knowledge, business cases, business process, strategic planning
Change	Managing business change, project management methods and tools
Data	Data analysis, data exchange, data management
Generic	Leadership, teamworking, interpersonal skills
Legal	Data protection laws, contract law, procurement law, fraud
Technology	Compute, storage, network infrastructure

Proficiency levels (Table 10-2, p. 266)

Level	Name	Description
1	Background	Basic understanding, but reliant on specialists.
2	Aware	Understands and can address issues, supported by specialists.
3	Knowledgeable	Good detail enabling effective decision-making; needs specialist input only in difficult situations.
4	Expert	Extensive experience; practical, applied knowledge.

Competencies versus skills (pp. 266-268)

A competency = skills + abilities + knowledge (Figure 10-8, p. 267). TOGAF lists skills and proficiency levels but **no competencies**, which Jager calls a gap. His anecdote: an organization that saw architecture purely as IT reduced his strategic role to IT scope, and he eventually ended the contract. His lesson is to agree on the architecture perspective before the work starts, so that the required skills and competencies match (pp. 267-268).

Jager's ten competencies (pp. 268-275, Table 10-3)

Competency	What it means	Main role emphasis (Table 10-3)
1. Strategic thinking and vision	Turn the long-term vision into strategy and initiatives on the Architecture Roadmap. Anticipate the future; think holistically.	Enterprise (and Segment)
2. Strategic decision-making	Decide under uncertainty. Present scenarios and trade-offs (Architecture Alternatives and Trade-Offs, Ch. 14.9). Prioritize by impact.	Enterprise (and Segment)

Competency	What it means	Main role emphasis (Table 10-3)
3. Leadership and influence	Guide and inspire teams, build consensus, and act as a trusted advisor to executives.	Enterprise
4. Change leadership	Drive organization-wide change with resilience, handle resistance, and support cultural change.	Enterprise (and Segment)
5. Business and technology alignment	Bridge strategy and technology. Explain technology value in business terms.	Enterprise and Segment
6. Communication and collaboration	Explain complex ideas to technical and non-technical audiences, listen, and collaborate across disciplines.	Segment and Solution (listening: all three)
7. Governance and compliance	Enforce standards, ensure regulatory compliance, and measure effectiveness (see the Ch. 8 framework).	All three
8. Adaptability and resilience	Adapt to changing landscapes, stay composed under pressure, and keep learning.	Mostly Segment and Solution; composure and learning: all three
9. Analytical thinking and problem solving	Break problems into manageable parts, find root causes, and apply creativity with structure.	All three (root-cause synthesis: Solution)
10. Systems thinking	Understand interconnectedness and design scalable, cohesive, sustainable solutions.	Segment and Solution

Each competency maps to a skill in the Series Guide (Figure 10-9, p. 276). For Segment and Solution Architects, Jager points to the **SFIA 9** skills directory as a further reference (p. 277).

10.5 Summary (pp. 277-278)

The summary covers the three primary viewpoints and core roles (Enterprise, with the Chief specialization; Segment, formerly Domain; Solution), the horizontal and vertical perspectives, and the fact that TOGAF describes only skills and proficiency levels. That gap is why the book adds ten competencies mapped to TOGAF's skills.

Key Terms & Definitions

Job (p. 248) — Formal position, usually defined by an employment contract and tied to hierarchical position.

Role (p. 248) — Expected set of activities, tied to a skill set.

Assignment (p. 248) — A specific task or project a person is responsible for.

Segment Architect (pp. 249, 253) — A TOGAF job profile, formerly Domain Architect. Defines and governs the systems and components within a segment.

Chief Architect (p. 251) — A specialization of the Enterprise Architect that integrates the EA view into the strategic and operational context.

Enterprise Architect (p. 252) — Leads organization-wide transformation and defines the principles and policies for integration, interoperability, and governance.

Solution Architect (p. 254) — Delivers new or evolved capabilities, typically one project or release, through Transition Architectures.

Segment (p. 256) — A structured grouping of capabilities, often part of a portfolio or change program.

Domain (p. 256) — Any useful grouping of capabilities to be managed. TOGAF has four segment-based viewpoints: business, application, data, and technology.

Horizontal perspective (p. 258) — Segments follow the four architecture domains.

Vertical perspective (p. 260) — Segments follow organizational pillars or business domains, each containing all architecture domains.

Skills framework (p. 264) — Defines roles, the skills required per role, and the depth of knowledge.

Proficiency level (p. 266) — 1 Background, 2 Aware, 3 Knowledgeable, 4 Expert.

Competency (p. 266) — Skills + abilities + knowledge.

Figures & Tables Referenced

Item	Page	Description
Figure 10-1 – Core architecture roles and their relationships	p. 250	Enterprise, segment, and solution viewpoints plus the specialist, user, and stakeholder perspectives.
Figure 10-2 – Core architecture roles	p. 251	Three tiers. The dashed line marks the Chief Architect as a specialization of the Enterprise Architect.
Figure 10-3 – Business domains/segments vs. architecture domains	p. 257	Vertical pillars against horizontal domains.
Figure 10-4 – Architecture Capabilities and architecture roles	p. 259	The four Ch. 9 capabilities mapped to roles.
Figure 10-5 – Capabilities, roles, and specializations	p. 260	Each role has two or more specializations.
Figure 10-6 – Vertical perspective and associated architectures	p. 261	Healthcare pillars: Research, Consultation, Treatment.
Figure 10-7 – Segment vs. Solution Architectures	p. 262	A Solution Architecture is a single project or release.
Table 10-1 – Skill categories	p. 265	Eight categories.
Table 10-2 – Proficiency levels	p. 266	Four levels.
Figure 10-8 – Competencies versus skills	p. 267	Competency = skills + abilities + knowledge.
Table 10-3 – Required competencies per core role	pp. 272-275	Ten competencies mapped to roles.
Figure 10-9 – Competencies mapped to skills	p. 276	Links Jager's competencies to TOGAF skills.

Key Takeaways / Exam Focus Points

- Job, role, and assignment are different things. Segment Architect is defined as a **job** (pp. 248-249).
- **Three primary viewpoints** (enterprise, segment, solution) correspond to the **three core roles**. The Chief Architect is a specialization of the Enterprise Architect, not a fourth core role (pp. 249-251).
- Segment Architect = the former **Domain Architect** (pp. 263, 277).
- Horizontal perspective = four domains (TOGAF Fundamental Content). Vertical perspective = organizational pillars (Series Guide only) (pp. 255-263).
- Capability-to-role mapping: Strategy goes to Chief/Enterprise, Portfolio and Projects go to Segment, and Solution Delivery goes to Solution (p. 259).

- Solution Architecture applies to a single project or release (p. 262).
- Eight skill categories (Application, Architecture, Business, Change, Data, Generic, Legal, Technology) and four proficiency levels (Background, Aware, Knowledgeable, Expert) (pp. 265-266).
- Competency = skills + abilities + knowledge. TOGAF defines **no competencies**. The ten competencies are Jager's addition (pp. 266-277).
- The Series Guide *Architecture Roles and Skills* (G249, September 2024) updated *Architecture Skills Framework* (G198) (p. 264).

Self-Check Questions

Q: Define job, role, and assignment.

A: Job: the formal position, usually contractual and hierarchical. Role: the expected set of activities tied to a skill set. Assignment: a specific task or project the person is responsible for (p. 248).

Q: Why did TOGAF create the Segment Architect profile, and is it a job or a role?

A: To remove ambiguity around domain-based architect titles. It describes a job, delivered as a package with a role description and responsibilities (p. 249).

Q: What are the three core architecture roles, and how does the Chief Architect relate to them?

A: Enterprise, Segment, and Solution Architect. The Chief Architect is a specialization of the Enterprise Architect (pp. 250-251).

Q: Contrast the horizontal and vertical perspectives on segments.

A: Horizontal: segments are the four architecture domains, which is TOGAF's Fundamental Content view. Vertical: segments are organizational pillars per core activity, each containing all four domains, which appears only in the Series Guide (pp. 256-261).

Q: Map the four Chapter 9 Architecture Capabilities to the core roles.

A: Support Strategy: Chief/Enterprise Architect. Support Portfolio and Support Projects: Segment Architect. Support Solution Delivery: Solution Architect (p. 259).

Q: How does a Segment Architecture differ from a Solution Architecture?

A: A Solution Architecture describes a discrete business operation and how IT supports it, typically for a single project or release. A Segment Architecture covers an entire pillar or domain (p. 262).

Q: List the four proficiency levels in order.

A: Background, Aware, Knowledgeable, Expert (p. 266).

Q: What is a competency, and what does TOGAF lack here?

A: Skills plus abilities plus knowledge. TOGAF lists skills and proficiency levels but no competencies (pp. 266, 277).

Q: Name at least five of Jager's ten competencies.

A: Strategic thinking and vision; strategic decision-making; leadership and influence; change leadership; business and technology alignment; communication and collaboration; governance and compliance; adaptability and resilience; analytical thinking and problem solving; systems thinking (pp. 268-271).

Q: What inconsistency exists between the Governance Framework and the Series Guide?

A: The Governance Framework (Ch. 8) names a Domain Architect and omits Segment and Solution Architects. The Series Guide uses Segment Architect and includes the Solution Architect (pp. 262-263).